

The SARS & CIPC Deadline Calendar

Every recurring submission a South African business owes, and when

WHO THIS IS FOR

Any business owner who has ever been surprised by a SARS penalty.

WHAT IS INSIDE

- A one-page table of every recurring deadline
- How each date is calculated from your own year end
- What a missed deadline costs, and the order to fix things in
- A month-by-month planner to put on the wall

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How to use this calendar

Most penalties are not caused by an unwillingness to pay. They are caused by a date nobody was watching. This calendar lists the submissions that repeat every year, and explains how each due date is worked out, so you can put them in your own diary rather than relying on a reminder that may never come.

Annual filing season dates for individuals and provisional taxpayers are announced by SARS each year and change. They are deliberately not printed here. Confirm the current season dates with us or on sars.gov.za.

The recurring deadlines

SUBMISSION	WHEN IT IS DUE	APPLIES TO
EMP201	By the 7th of the month after the payroll month, or the last business day before it	Every employer
VAT201	By the 25th of the month after the tax period, or the last business day of that month when filing on eFiling	VAT vendors
EMP501 (interim)	After the August payroll, in the window SARS announces	Every employer
EMP501 (annual)	After the February payroll, in the window SARS announces	Every employer
IRP6 first period	Within six months of the start of the year of assessment (31 August for a February year end)	Provisional taxpayers
IRP6 second period	By the last day of the year of assessment	Provisional taxpayers
IRP6 third (voluntary)	Usually six months after year end (30 September for a February year end)	Provisional taxpayers
ITR14	Within twelve months of the company's financial year end	Every company
CIPC annual return	Within 30 business days of the registration anniversary	Companies and CCs
Beneficial ownership	With the annual return	Companies

SUBMISSION	WHEN IT IS DUE	APPLIES TO
COIDA return of earnings	Annually, in the window the Compensation Fund announces	Every employer

Working out your own dates

Three things determine your calendar: your financial year end, your VAT category, and your payroll cycle. Write them down once and the rest follows.

- ☐ My financial year end is: _____
- ☐ My VAT category (A, B, C, D or E) is: _____
- ☐ My VAT periods end in the months: _____
- ☐ My company registration anniversary is: _____
- ☐ My payroll is processed on the _____ of each month

Your VAT category is allocated by SARS and appears on your VAT registration. It is not a matter of preference, and it determines which two-month cycle you fall into.

What a missed deadline actually costs

- Administrative penalties for outstanding returns recur every month until the return is filed. Filing stops the clock, which is why filing always comes before negotiating.
- Interest on unpaid tax runs separately from penalties and is far harder to have reversed.
- SARS can appoint a third party — your bank or your customer — to pay a tax debt out of your money, without negotiating with you first.
- A company that does not file its CIPC annual return is placed in deregistration, which can freeze bank accounts and make contracts unenforceable.
- A late EMP501 delays every employee's IRP5, which delays their own tax returns.

If you are already behind

Being years behind is more common than you would think, and it is fixable. The order matters.

- ☐ List every registration you hold: income tax, VAT, PAYE, UIF, SDL, COIDA, CIPC
- ☐ Pull a statement of account for each tax type from eFiling
- ☐ Identify every outstanding return, oldest first
- ☐ File the outstanding returns — this stops new penalties accruing
- ☐ Only then request remission of penalties, with your reasons in writing
- ☐ Agree a payment arrangement for what is genuinely owed
- ☐ Put the recurring dates in a diary so it does not happen again

Requesting remission before the returns are filed almost always fails. Get current first.

Month-by-month planner

Print this page. For a February year end, a typical year looks like the following. Adjust the provisional tax and annual return months to your own dates.

MONTH	WHAT FALLS DUE
Every month	EMP201 by the 7th
Every second month	VAT201 (depending on your category)
August	First provisional tax payment (February year end)
September / October	Interim EMP501 reconciliation window
September	Third (voluntary) provisional payment for the prior year
February	Second provisional tax payment; financial year end
April / May	Annual EMP501 reconciliation window; IRP5 certificates issued
Your anniversary month	CIPC annual return and beneficial ownership filing
Fund's announced window	COIDA return of earnings

Would you rather not do this yourself?

We have kept books, filed returns and run payrolls from Amanzimtoti since 1980. Twenty minutes on the phone costs nothing and usually saves something.

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This document is general information about South African accounting and tax practice. It is not advice for your particular circumstances, and rules change — usually with the annual Budget. Confirm anything you intend to rely on.